

Hello

I'm a UX research and strategy leader driving user-centered innovation and practice growth for high-growth companies and complex systems.



CAROL BALES

USER RESEARCH

Alignment with UX Research & Strategy



Proven UX Research & Design Leader

15+ years in research and 20+ years in UX design across SaaS, B2C, B2B, enterprise. Deep experience with qualitative and quantitative research methodologies.



Research Operations and Team Manager

Led high-volume mixed-methods team and managed research operations and practice building introducing standards and practices.



Clear, Action-Oriented Storyteller

Translate complex findings into actionable insights for leaders & teams, championing the voice of the consumer.



Embracing Innovation

MS in Human-Computer Interaction (Georgia Tech) with focus on creative processes; teach HCI at GSU. Comfortable with the ambiguity of innovating with emerging tech.



Trusted Strategic Partner

Recognized thought leader at TWC; aligned ELT, stakeholders and product teams on strategy, bringing clarity, focus, and collaboration.

Career Impact Snapshot



400M+

users



Research insights informed critical product decisions across IBM/The Weather Company's global audience.

37%

efficiency gain



Improved subscription purchase flow using iterative usability testing.

+26%

NPS growth



Enhanced newsletter engagement through quarterly metrics research.

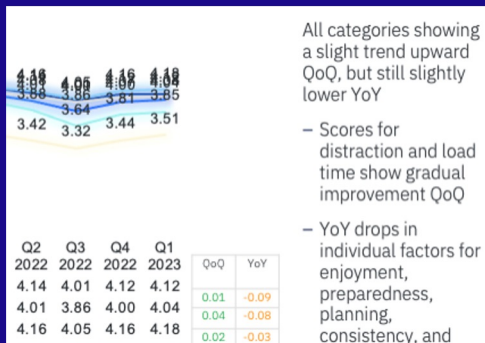
Leadership & Strategy Highlights



Recognized impact as a thought leader and highly productive practitioner.

Strengthened research practice.

Scaled research influence across the org by launching a monthly research showcase, a quarterly UX benchmark program, and a centralized research repository — bringing new business areas and stakeholders into the fold.



All categories showing a slight trend upward QoQ, but still slightly lower YoY

- Scores for distraction and load time show gradual improvement QoQ
- YoY drops in individual factors for enjoyment, preparedness, planning, consistency, and

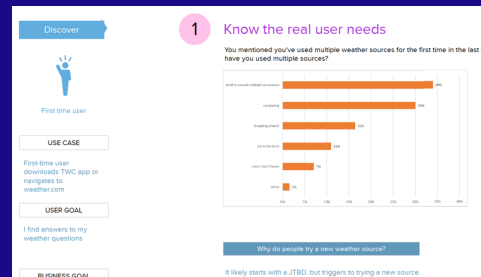
Agile Design, rooted in research

Built a Jobs-to-be-Done storytelling framework in Mural that empowered teams to write user stories reflecting both consumer product and ad sales perspectives — aligning priorities across silos.



Customer roadmap, grounded in evidence

Partnered with Product and Marketing to create a research-backed customer journey map that captured user goals, churn drivers, and weather-related jobs-to-be-done — directly shaping retention and acquisition strategies.

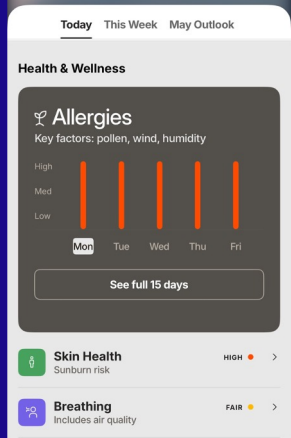


Design Research Project Highlights



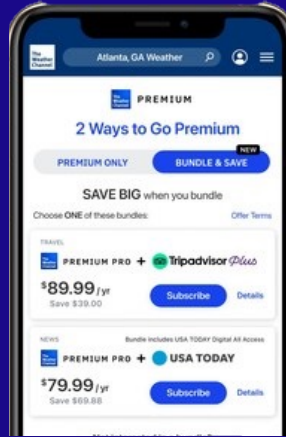
Driving product growth and user engagement through actionable research.

Mixed-method research to identify unmet needs



Qual and quant research into well-being and weather lead to new features and content in app redesign

RITE Method to increase purchase completion



Iterative testing cleared blockers in the purchase scenario and improved usability improved by 37%

Research to predict likelihood to subscribe



Novel features and content were evaluated for popularity and potential lift to subscriber audience. The high scorer launched as a premium offering

Proven impact for Fortune 500s & high growth innovators





Some guiding principles

Audience needs and business needs aren't a trade-off – they're a Venn diagram

Open, transparent communication earns the trust to make tough decisions easier

Structure and flexibility are possible at the same time

Leadership sets the north star, then removes obstacles from the path

True innovation requires organizational courage to fail



Thank you.

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